Supplementary

Stone Soup

One day, a traveller came into a village. He was very tired and hungry from his journey. The village was dark. No one was in the streets. It seemed an unhappy place. The traveller stopped at the first house and knocked on the door.

A woman opened the door.

"Who are you?" the woman asked the traveller.

"I am a tired and hungry traveller," he said. "Please, may I have something to eat?"

"There is no food here," said the woman. "You will not find anyone with extra food to give. We are all poor and hungry too." And the woman closed the door.

The traveller, however, had a plan. He picked a large, round stone from the ground and knocked once more at the door. The lady came to the door again.

"Yes?" she asked opening the door halfway.

"Would you like to have some of my stone soup? This stone will make very good soup!"

"Stone soup?" the woman laughed. "You can't make soup from a stone!"

"I've done it before, and it can be very tasty," replied the traveller.

The woman had never seen or heard anything like it but she was hungry too. She let him in. Then she lit the fire and placed a pot of water on top. The traveller placed the stone inside the water.The water boiled. He sipped a spoonful of hot liquid.

"It's almost ready," he said. "But if you had just a little salt and butter, the soup would taste much better!"

The woman went to the cupboard and returned with salt and butter. The traveller added them to the pot. Just then, the woman's husband came home. He had onions and potatoes in a bag.

"What are you making?" asked the woman's husband. "Stone soup!" replied the woman and the traveller. "Impossible!" said the husband.

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